VANTA
MINDFUL AI

The whole platform, end to end.
What it can do, what it can't, and where it goes next.

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Capture never executes. Plan → Approve → Execute happens only inside the platform.

The short version

READ THIS IF YOU READ NOTHING ELSE

Vanta is not a chatbot with features bolted on. It is an operational memory with a mouth. Things arrive from everywhere you already live — voice, email, Telegram, uploads, forms, other platforms — and they land as records first. Vanta then notices what those records mean, and when something is worth your attention it says so once, in plain English, and stops.

The one law the whole build hangs on:

> *Messaging feeds the system. It does not control it. Nothing executes from a chat window. Plan → Approve → Execute happens inside the platform, with a human hand on it, every time.*

Measured today, that is 4 rooms (Today, Work, Ask, Receipts), 10 specialist desks under Work, 50 backend functions, 67 database tables, a deterministic awareness pipeline in eleven stages, and roughly 460 automated tests holding it in place.

THE VERDICT, ONE LINE

The intelligence layer is further along than the explanation layer. Vanta already thinks well. It does not yet always tell a new person what it is thinking, or why. That gap — not missing features — is the whole opportunity, and most of it sits in Work.

Where it actually stands

LAYER	STATE	PLAIN READING
Capture	Strong	Voice, files, clipboard, email, Telegram, webhooks, share sheet. Little gets in the way of getting something in.
Awareness / judgment	Strong	Eleven deterministic stages. Quiet hours, attention budget, shadow mode, dedupe. It has taste about when to speak.
Action safety	Strong	Plan → Approve → Execute, confirm dialog, rollback, receipt. Nothing runs itself.
Scope isolation	Strong	Personal / Workspace / Admin enforced at the query layer and in signal identity.
Ask	Good	Durable threads, attachments, research, capability routing. Round-trips into Work.
Work	Crowded	Ten desks, all real, all useful — and all presented at roughly equal weight. This is the weak spot.
Explaining itself	Uneven	Glossary, desk roles, aftermath hints and Why-this exist, but coverage is patchy.
Senses beyond the desk	Partial	Calendar reads. Location is coarse. No wearables, camera-as-sense, or voice out — deliberately.

What it can do today

CAPABILITIES, TRACED TO CODE — NOT ASPIRATIONS

Get things in

— Speak a note and have it transcribed and filed.

— Drop, paste or share a file from any app; it stages, extracts and offers to attach.

— Forward an email — body and attachments both land as a capture.

— Message Telegram; the message becomes a record, never a command.

— Receive structured events from other platforms: Ground Truth Hub, CampCore, Fenrir, website forms.

Hold and connect

— Projects gather everything for one job: notes, promises, files, briefs.

— Memory searches everything ever held, by meaning as well as by word.

— The entity graph resolves people and places so "Nikki" is one person, not five strings.

— Working memory ranks what is currently live, so answers are grounded in real records.

— Continuity carries a thread across a 90-day gap and tells you where you left off.

Notice and speak

— Drift detection: silent projects, slipping promises, unread risk.

— Calendar sense: meetings starting, collisions with promises, and a real diff — new, moved, cancelled — never just "synchronized".

— Sherlock investigates patterns across object types and flags quiet problems.

— One nudge at a time, per scope, respecting quiet hours and an attention budget.

— Delivery to Today always; Telegram and phone push when you have opted in.

Decide and do

— Actions are drafted, never run. You read the detail, confirm, and only then does anything happen.

— Every execution produces a receipt, and most can be rolled back.

— Commitments track promises with dates — yours and other people's — with complete, move, or hand off.

— Briefs and Documents produce something you can actually send: PDF or Word, with flagged risks on contracts.

Prove it happened

— Receipts is a full audit trail: every state change, who, when, and why.

— Approvals and executions are receipts, not log lines. They read like thermal print, on purpose.

What it cannot do

SAID PLAINLY, SO NOBODY IS SURPRISED

Half of this list is a limitation. The other half is a decision. They are marked, because confusing the two is how a product gets ruined.

IT CANNOT…	WHY
Execute anything from Telegram, WhatsApp or SMS	Decision. Messaging is a capture layer. Permanent.
Act on its own without approval	Decision. Every side effect passes a human. Permanent.
Write to your calendar	Decision, for now. Calendars are read-only; a write path needs its own consent and rollback story.
Speak out loud, or listen continuously	Not built. Voice output and ambient listening are seams only.
Read wearables, vehicle, camera, NFC or smart-home	Deliberately deferred. These need posture and per-family consent to exist first, or they land as gimmicks.
Sync a mailbox	Not built. Email is inbound-to-capture only, not a two-way mailbox.
Know precisely where you are	Coarse only. Geocoding and nearby-places are approximate by design.
Learn your attention habits automatically	Not built. The attention budget is fixed rules, not a learned model.
Run AI without you tapping something	Decision. No automatic model calls. Cost and surprise are both bad.
Be used anonymously	Decision. Every record has an owner and a scope.

THE HONEST CAVEAT

Vanta is confident about records and cautious about the world. Anything it read — a calendar entry, an inbound booking, an extracted contract term — is only as good as the source. It shows provenance for exactly this reason. If it doesn't know, it says so rather than guessing well.

The Work room

WHERE THE FRICTION ACTUALLY IS

Work is the strongest part of the system and the hardest part to walk into cold. Ten desks — Projects, Inbox, Commitments, Actions, Briefs, Documents, Memory, Schedule, Sherlock, Awareness, plus the Cockpit — each earn their place. The problem is not that any one of them is wrong. The problem is that Work presents them as a menu of ten equal choices, and a menu of ten equal choices is a decision, not a room.

What a first-timer experiences

— No obvious starting point. Ten tiles, no gravity.

— Overlapping mental models: is a promise a Commitment, an Action, or an item in a Project?

— The desks that only read (Memory, Sherlock, Awareness, Cockpit) sit beside the desks where work actually lands, with no visual distinction.

— Nothing on the surface tells you the state of your work before you pick a desk.

Five fixes, in order, none of them new features

1. Give Work a front page, not a directory. The room should open with the state of your work in one screen: what needs a decision, what is drifting, what is due, what arrived. Desks stay, but they move below the fold — reached because you want detail, not because you had to choose.

2. Split the desks into two shelves. "Where work lands" (Projects, Inbox, Commitments, Actions, Briefs, Documents, Schedule) and "Where Vanta looks" (Memory, Sherlock, Awareness, Cockpit). Two labelled shelves turn ten decisions into two, and the second shelf explains itself by its own heading.

3. Make one desk the obvious next tap. Whichever desk has the most pressure — three unsorted arrivals, an action waiting on approval — gets promoted with a plain-English reason. "Start here: 3 things came in." Everything else stays quiet.

4. Finish the aftermath sweep. Every card should answer the same four questions: what is this, what happened, what can I do, what happens if I tap. The primitives exist — card-meta, provenance, freshness, why-this, aftermath hints. Coverage is the gap, not capability. This is the single highest-yield pass left.

5. Show the object's life, not just its state. A promise should carry its own short history inline: captured here, filed there, moved once, due Friday. Right now that story lives in Receipts and you have to go and get it.

> **WHAT NOT TO DO IN WORK**
> Do not add an eleventh desk. Do not add a settings page for Work. Do not add a second inbox. The room does not need more surface — it needs a hierarchy and a first sentence.

Making it more user-friendly

ACROSS THE WHOLE PLATFORM

MOVE	WHY IT PAYS	SIZE
Work front page + two shelves	Turns the busiest room from a directory into a briefing.	Medium
Universal aftermath coverage	Every card teaches its own next step. Removes most "now what?" moments.	Medium
Inline object history	Answers "how did this get here" without leaving the card.	Small
Empty states that teach	An empty desk should say how something gets there. Half already do.	Small
One vocabulary, enforced	Nouns are defined in one file; the UI does not use them everywhere yet.	Small
Confidence on every read	When Vanta inferred rather than read, say so on the card, not in a tooltip.	Small
Undo everywhere it is possible	Rollback exists in the engine; the UI only offers it in places.	Small
First-run: one real note	Walk a new user through a single capture to its aftermath. The demo exists; make it the default first experience.	Medium

The mobile test that matters

384 pixels, one thumb, a bad connection, standing up. If a screen fails that test it fails, regardless of how it looks on a desk. Today and Ask pass. Work and the denser desks pass technically but ask for too much reading. Shortening copy on those cards is worth more than any new component.

Where it goes from here

EXPANSION THAT EARNS ITS KEEP

Every candidate below is judged on one question: does it make Vanta more of a companion, or just more of a product? Anything that only adds surface is refused by name at the end.

Near — the next two moves

1. The Work front page and the aftermath sweep. No new capability, large gain in trust. This should come before anything else on this page.

2. Cross-device context that actually carries. The record and the merge logic exist and nothing reads them yet. Start a thought on the phone, finish it at the desk, and Vanta knows it is the same thought. That is companion behaviour, and it is mostly wiring already in place.

Mid — worth doing, in this order

— Calendar write-back, gated. Read-only was right to start. Blocking time for a promise is the first write worth the consent conversation — as a drafted action with a receipt, like everything else.

— Mailbox sense. Inbound email works; a read-only mailbox view would let Vanta notice the promise you made in a reply you already sent.

— Automatic posture, suggested not applied. Vanta can guess you are training or driving and ask once. It must never set posture silently.

— Second messaging channel: WhatsApp. Capture-only, same as Telegram. This is Nikki's whole interface and the rollout order is already set — Vanta, then Ground Truth Hub, then CampCore.

— Shared workspace rhythm. A manager-facing daily summary of a workspace, not just a person. The pipeline already scopes per organization.

Later — only after the above

— Spoken output, for the drive and the gym. Compression already renders a spoken form; nothing speaks it.

— Camera as a deliberate sense — a "look at this" flow, not silent background vision.

— Wearables, if and only if posture and per-family consent are mature.

— Learned attention: Vanta adapting its own budget from what you dismissed. Needs a long history to be honest.

> **REFUSED BY NAME**
> A fifth room. A second chat surface. Chat commands that execute. Auto-posting to social. Generic dashboards with charts nobody reads. A plugin marketplace. Gamification. Streaks. An AI that acts while you sleep. Each of these adds surface and subtracts trust.

The verdict

WHAT THIS ACTUALLY IS

Most tools in this space are a chat box with a database behind it. The chat box is the product and the database is an implementation detail. Vanta is built the other way around: the record is the product, and conversation is one of several ways to reach it. That inversion is why the safety story holds. You cannot talk Vanta into doing something, because talking is not a control surface.

Judged as a digital companion rather than as software, the maturity reads like this:

COMPANION TRAIT	GRADE	NOTE
Remembers	A	Deep, searchable, connected, and it survives long gaps.
Notices	A-	Deterministic judgment with real restraint. Rare in this category.
Speaks well	B+	Voice is warm and jargon-free; coverage of explanation is uneven.
Knows when to shut up	A	Quiet hours, attention budget, one nudge at a time, shadow mode.
Is safe to trust	A	Approval gate, receipts, rollback, scope isolation. No shortcuts taken.
Is easy to walk into	C+	Today and Ask are fine. Work is the wall.
Senses the world	C	Calendar and coarse location only. Honest about it, which counts.
Follows you across devices	C	PWA and push work; context does not travel yet.

So what is it, honestly

It is a genuinely mature operational companion with an onboarding problem in one room. That is a far better position than a beautiful shell with nothing underneath, and it is the harder half to build. The remaining work is mostly editorial: hierarchy, first sentences, and finishing a sweep that is already half done.

The discipline is the asset

The most valuable thing in this build is the list of things it refuses to do. Capture never executes. No automatic AI calls. No fifth room. No silent action. Those constraints are why Vanta can be handed to someone who runs a real business without a long conversation about risk. Protect the refusals harder than the features — features can be rebuilt, and a reputation for surprising people cannot.

> **BOTTOM LINE**
> Vanta already behaves like a companion. It does not yet always explain that it is one. Spend the next pass on Work's hierarchy and universal aftermath, then on carrying context across devices. Ship nothing that talks before it is asked, and nothing that acts before it is told.